



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cedar Hall Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.cedarhallclassical.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Cedar Hall Classical Academy TX 76021 presents a robust classical Christian model across all six categories of the classical rubric. Public materials foreground gospel-centered, theologically grounded education anchored in the Western classical tradition, the seven liberal arts, and a strong emphasis on the formation of virtue, wisdom, and character. The school explicitly centers on a living faith, partnership with families, and a mentor-based faculty structure, with Curricular and Pedagogical commitments that align with Great Books, Latin/Greek-inspired study, and the integration of faith with reason. Public-facing materials consistently emphasize the Great Books, the seven liberal arts, and a collaborative, home-school partnership model, with strong parental involvement and a two-day hybrid format that preserves rest and contemplative learning (Scholé) alongside rigorous study. Overall, Cedar Hall Classical Academy is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize gospel-centeredness and a Christ-centered mission, including explicit calls for families to be connected to a local church and to prioritize Christ's glory above other goals.
 - The school identifies as providing a Christ-centered, theologically informed classical education and frames education in terms of a biblical/sacred horizon.
 - Foundational language references living faith, sacred tradition, and a theological frame for learning (e.g., "great books... western tradition" through a Christian lens).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: gospel-centeredness, Christ, local church, theology, the Logos (implicit), worship/communal sensibilities, great books, Western tradition, seven liberal arts, truth/-goodness/beauty, living faith, living books, virtue.
 - Negative keywords observed: none detected in public materials (no explicit secular relativism, value-neutral ethics, or prescriptive "progressive" signals found in the site text).
- Why this rating
 - The materials decisively anchor education in a Christian theological worldview, with explicit corporate worship/communal connections and a worldview that treats truth, goodness, and beauty as real targets of the educative project. This aligns strongly with the classical rubric's Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, yielding CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school speaks of forming virtue and wisdom rather than mere information or job-preparation, emphasizing character and virtue development.

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- Statements describe education as formation and the cultivation of wisdom and virtue, with references to the true, good, and beautiful as real aims of education.
 - The mission elevates lifelong character formation in a liberal-arts framework, consistent with classical telos.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful, great conversation, liberal education, moral imagination, soulful formation.
 - Negative keywords observed: none detected (no emphasis on job-readiness or narrow workforce metrics in the public materials).
 - Why this rating
 - The materials consistently present education as formation of character and intellect toward human flourishing, not solely preparation for employment. This squarely matches CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The curriculum centers on the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) and explicitly references Great Books/Western tradition.
 - History is treated as a throughline across the curriculum rather than as a mere social studies unit; humanities drive a broad classical curriculum, including Bible/history/geography/literature/composition and a classical timeline.
 - Latin (and Spanish) offerings, as well as other classical subjects, are listed in the academics structure.
 - The program emphasizes the Great Conversation and a lifelong engagement with great books and Western civilization.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy; Great Books; Western tradition/civilization; history (through humanities); Latin; classical education; wonder.
 - Negative keywords observed: none detected (no shift toward social studies terminology replacing history; no project-based-first framing detected in the public materials).
- Why this rating
 - The curriculum is explicitly liberal-arts-driven, anchored in Great Books and Western heritage, with a clear emphasis on the full spectrum of the liberal arts and language study, which aligns with CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The materials describe a restful, contemplative “Scholé” approach in parts of the program, alongside rigorous study; lower-grammar stage uses singing/chanting/memory-friendly review; upper grades lean into Socratic-like seminars and rhetoric/theory work, with opportunities for speeches and rhetoric training.
 - The school identifies a Charlotte Mason-inspired pedagogy in the lower grades and emphasizes the “living books” and a cooperative, mentor-led model with parents involved in the pedagogy.
 - Upper-level classical practices include dialogue/seminars and the cultivation of rhetoric, with opportunities to present and argue (rhetoric training).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: Scholé/restful learning, contemplation, wonder; Socratic dialogue/seminar; narration/recitation/chanting; formation through imitation; living books; rhetoric; public speaking.
 - Negative keywords observed: minimal evidence of a purely project-based or constructivist-only pedagogy; no dominant experiential-learning-only language detected in the public materials.
- Why this rating

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- The pedagogy blends contemplative, memorization-based and spoken-heritage methods (recitation, chant, living books) with higher-grade Socratic dialogue and rhetoric—core elements of classical pedagogy. This yields CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school describes mentor-teachers who are fellow homeschooling parents or contracted professionals, with explicit expectations to teach content, develop skills, and communicate with parents about student progress; the faculty are described as living curriculum and core to the school's mission.
 - There is a strong emphasis on character formation and virtuous exemplars in the teaching model, with professional development and alignment to scholé/classical traditions.
 - The “portrait of a teacher” and “faculty as living curriculum” language is reflected in the About Us materials, including Christian/virtue-centered expectations.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; Christian/classical pedagogy; mentorship; intellectual virtue.
 - Negative keywords observed: none detected in the public materials.
- Why this rating
 - The faculty model is explicitly described as mentors living within a shared classical-Christian formation framework, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school emphasizes partnership with families, including parents as co-teachers and home-school collaboration; parent formation via book studies and gatherings; and open campus with opportunities for parent visits and involvement.
 - Parent roles are defined (parents help with core work, support learning at home, attend trainings), reflecting a shared mission between families and school.
 - The school stresses a vibrant faith-community environment and parental involvement in community-building events.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, book clubs, parent involvement, open campus, mentorship, home-school collaboration.
 - Negative keywords observed: none detected (no signals of consumer-only relationships or minimal parent involvement).
- Why this rating
 - The school's materials depict parents as essential partners and co-educators, with formal structures for parental involvement and learning opportunities, matching CLASSICAL.

aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- Overall assessment
 - Cedar Hall Classical Academy TX 76021 demonstrates a coherent CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories. The public materials align with the Six Essential Elements framework: religious/metaphysical foundations, formation-focused goals, a liberal-arts curriculum, contemplative-pedagogical methods, a mentor-based faculty, and a partnership with parents/-community.
- What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases only)
 - Not applicable here, as all six categories meet CLASSICAL criteria. If desired, minor refinements could include more explicit articulation of liturgical practices across all grade levels or further documentation of the Great Books sequence across the full K–12 program. No major needle-moving changes are required.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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